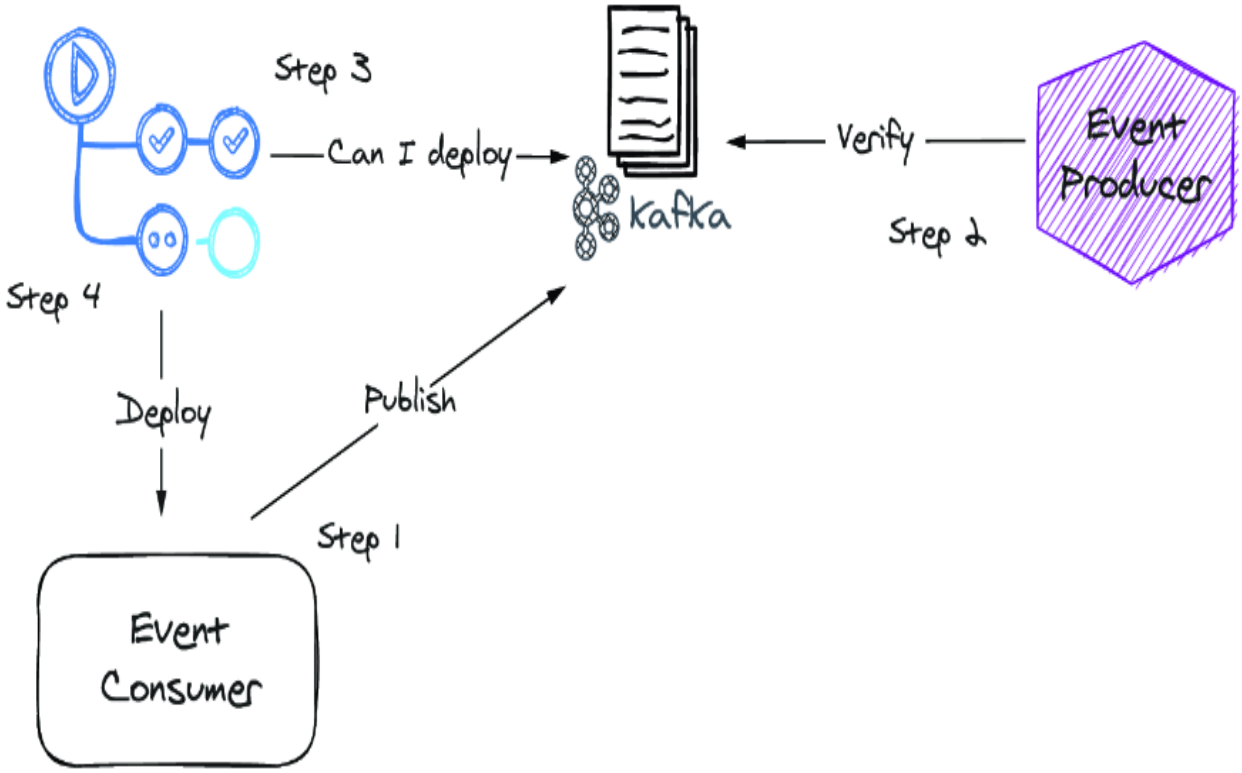


Figure 3.15 Event-driven architecture life cycle applied to PDCT using Kafka through the contract store broker, finally checking can-i-deploy in CI

As confusing as the crossover of terminology between event-driven architecture and contract testing is, contract testing provides a simple way to verify that the messages are in the right format and contain the right information. Tools such as Protocol Buffers (https://protobuf.dev/) can mitigate these problems as a static way to share the message format. We'll explore contract testing with event-driven architectures such as ActiveMQ, Kafka, and Rabbit in chapter 8.

Summary

- A consumer is a user of a service and the owner of the contract tests in PDCT.
- The provider makes the service available and gains confidence in its implementation by verifying consumer contracts.
- A contract is a representation of consumer interactions with the provider service.